





What laws recognize the collective rights of the Metis?

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■ The Metis were sometimes given the choice of accepting the scrip or become “Treaty Indians” under a Numbered Treaty.

■ The Canadian government did not see the Metis as having the same rights to land as the First Nations. Ottawa moved 1,500 troops into the province, and white settlers began to arrive in large numbers. Protestant Ontarians regarded Manitoba as a 'half-breed' province, and this spiteful attitude was reflected in future actions.

■ As little as 15 percent of the original 1.4 million acres promised under the Act were ever distributed.

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DOMINION OF CANADA

Department of the Interior

DOMINION LANDS BRANCH.

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The Bearer hereof is entitled to
 receive for *Twenty Dollars* currency paid for
 (OF DOMINION LANDS.)

Issued at the Dominion Land Office at Ottawa
 this 30th day of May 1891

Cancelled
CANCELLED
Director of the Interior



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- 1896-1910, Metis farms were established at St. Paul des Metis on land provided by the Catholic Church. The Metis however did not have title to the land and had to move when the settlement closed.
- In 1938, *L'Association des Metis de l'Alberta et des Territoires du Nord-Ouest* lobbied the Alberta government for Metis land.
- In 1938 the Metis Population Betterment Act was passed by Alberta's government establishing twelve temporary Metis settlements. This was the first time a government had granted land to the Metis.
- The settlements did not give control of the land to the Metis and when the settlements were found to be unsuitable for farming, hunting and fishing the settlements went back to the Alberta government.
- In 1982, the Metis lobbied for inclusion in the Charter. Section 35 recognizes the Metis as Aboriginal peoples.